

Bank of Leeds

Funding, Support & Investment

Empowering Yorkshire's Small Businesses

A Prospectus for SMEs, Entrepreneurs and Family Businesses

Building Yorkshire, One Business at a Time

The Bank of Leeds exists for one purpose:

To finance the growth of Yorkshire.

We believe that prosperous communities are built by successful local businesses—not by distant financial institutions.

Whether you are opening a café in Sheffield, expanding a manufacturing business in Bradford, launching a software company in Leeds, or developing a family farm in the Yorkshire Dales, the Bank of Leeds is committed to providing the capital, advice and long-term partnership needed to help your business succeed.

Yorkshire is home to nearly **388,000 small and medium-sized enterprises**, representing around 7% of the UK's SME population, and remains one of Britain's largest regional business economies.

Why the Bank of Leeds?

Unlike traditional commercial banks, our objective is not simply to maximise lending volumes.

Our objective is to build productive businesses that strengthen Yorkshire's economy for generations.

We invest in:

- Independent retailers
- Manufacturers
- Hospitality businesses
- Technology companies
- Creative industries
- Family-owned enterprises
- Agricultural businesses
- Professional services

- Tourism and leisure
- Exporting businesses

Every successful Yorkshire business strengthens the region through employment, investment and innovation.

Our Business Finance Products

Start-Up Loan

Helping entrepreneurs turn ideas into businesses.

- £5,000–£50,000
- Up to 7-year repayment
- Competitive fixed rates
- Business mentoring included

Ideal for:

- New retailers
 - Cafés
 - Online businesses
 - Service companies
 - Tradespeople
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Growth Loan

Helping established businesses expand.

- £25,000–£500,000
- Property improvements
- New equipment
- Working capital
- Additional staff
- New premises

Suitable for businesses with a proven trading history and growth plans.

Yorkshire Retail Fund

Designed specifically for high street businesses.

Funding for:

- Shop refurbishment
- Interior design
- Stock purchasing
- EPOS systems
- Digital transformation
- Accessibility improvements
- Outdoor seating
- Energy efficiency

Supporting independent Yorkshire town centres.

Manufacturing Investment Loan

Supporting Yorkshire's industrial heritage.

Finance for:

- CNC machinery
 - Robotics
 - Factory expansion
 - Warehouse automation
 - Export growth
 - Renewable energy
 - Productivity improvements
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Tourism & Hospitality Fund

Helping Yorkshire welcome the world.

Finance available for:

- Hotels
- Guest houses
- Restaurants
- Farm shops

- Visitor attractions
 - Wedding venues
 - Holiday parks
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Commercial Property Finance

Helping businesses own their future.

Available for:

- Retail units
 - Offices
 - Industrial premises
 - Mixed-use developments
 - Business parks
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Green Business Loan

Supporting sustainable investment.

Funding for:

- Solar panels
 - Electric vehicle fleets
 - Heat pumps
 - Building insulation
 - Low-carbon equipment
 - Sustainable manufacturing
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Equity Investment

For ambitious Yorkshire businesses seeking long-term growth.

The Bank of Leeds Growth Capital Fund provides equity investment for businesses with significant expansion potential.

Typical investments:

- £100,000–£2 million

Suitable for:

- Technology companies
- Manufacturing businesses
- Life sciences
- Food production
- Creative industries
- Export businesses

We invest alongside experienced management teams with the ambition to scale nationally and internationally.

Beyond Banking

Business Support Programme

Every funded business receives access to:

- Business planning assistance
- Financial forecasting
- Export advice
- Digital transformation support
- Marketing guidance
- Recruitment advice
- Leadership development
- Networking opportunities

Finance should come with expertise—not just capital.

Yorkshire Business Network

Customers automatically become members of the Yorkshire Business Network.

Benefits include:

- Quarterly networking events
- Meet-the-investor sessions
- Supplier introductions
- Export opportunities
- Procurement events

- University partnerships
- Apprenticeship programmes

Our objective is to create a stronger Yorkshire business community.

Community Investment

Every investment made by the Bank of Leeds contributes to wider regional prosperity.

We measure success not only by financial returns but also by:

- Jobs created
 - Businesses started
 - High streets regenerated
 - Apprenticeships supported
 - Exports increased
 - Productivity improvements
 - Local supply chains strengthened
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Yorkshire Priority Sectors

The Bank of Leeds is particularly interested in supporting businesses operating in:

- Advanced manufacturing
- Engineering
- Food and drink
- Health technology
- Artificial intelligence
- Financial technology
- Construction
- Tourism
- Retail
- Logistics
- Creative industries
- Professional services

These sectors align with Yorkshire's existing strengths and future economic opportunities.

Why Regional Banking Matters

Recent UK evidence shows that access to finance remains one of the biggest barriers to SME growth, despite improving lending conditions. Around half of smaller businesses seek external finance, while challenger banks and specialist lenders now account for a majority of SME lending.

The Bank of Leeds seeks to complement this market by combining regional knowledge with patient capital.

Working Alongside Existing Support

Where appropriate, the Bank of Leeds would work with existing programmes such as government-backed guarantee schemes and regional investment funds to increase the amount of finance available to Yorkshire businesses rather than replacing them. Existing initiatives include the British Business Bank's Growth Guarantee Scheme and Finance Yorkshire's debt and equity funds.

Our Vision

Imagine a Yorkshire where:

- Every town has thriving independent retailers.
- Every entrepreneur can access affordable finance.
- Family businesses pass successfully to the next generation.
- Manufacturing expands rather than contracts.
- Local savings are invested in local enterprises.
- Prosperity is created and retained within Yorkshire.

This is the purpose of the Bank of Leeds.

Investing in Yorkshire. Backing Yorkshire. Building Yorkshire.